BLUE SHIELD HEALTH INSURANCE POLICY

Policy Number: BSH-2024-004521

Effective Date: January 1, 2024

Policyholder: Jane Doe

This document sets out the terms and conditions of your health insurance coverage with Blue Shield Health Insurance Company. Please read it carefully and keep it in a safe place. Contact member services if you have any questions about your benefits.

1. ELIGIBILITY

1.1 Who Is Eligible

Coverage under this policy is available to individuals who meet all of the following criteria: are between the ages of 18 and 65 at the time of enrollment, are legal residents of the United States, have not been diagnosed with a pre-existing condition in the 12 months prior to enrollment, and have submitted a completed application form along with the required premium payment.

1.2 Dependents

Eligible policyholders may enroll their spouse or domestic partner and dependent children under the age of 26. Dependent children who are full-time students remain eligible until the age of 26 regardless of their state of residence. Documentation of dependent status must be provided within 30 days of enrollment.

1.3 Enrollment Periods

Open enrollment runs from November 1 to December 15 each year, with coverage beginning on January 1 of the following year. Special enrollment periods of 60 days are available following qualifying life events including marriage, birth or adoption of a child, loss of other coverage, or relocation to a new service area.

2. COVERAGE

2.1 Covered Services

This policy covers the following medical services when provided by an in-network provider: preventive care and annual wellness exams, primary care visits, specialist consultations, emergency room services, urgent care visits, hospitalization and inpatient surgery, outpatient surgery and procedures, laboratory tests and diagnostic imaging, prescription drugs listed on the formulary, mental health and substance use disorder treatment, physical therapy up to 30 sessions per calendar year, and maternity and newborn care.

2.2 Preventive Care

Preventive care services are covered at 100% with no cost-sharing when provided by an in-network provider. Covered preventive services include annual physical exams, recommended immunizations, cancer screenings, blood pressure and cholesterol checks, and routine gynecological exams.

2.3 Emergency Services

Emergency room services are covered regardless of whether the provider is in-network or out-of-network. The policyholder is responsible for the applicable emergency copayment listed in Section 4. If the policyholder is admitted to the hospital following an emergency room visit, the inpatient cost-sharing applies rather than the emergency copayment.

2.4 Prescription Drugs

Prescription drugs are covered according to the four-tier formulary:

Tier 1 (Generic): $10 copay per 30-day supply

Tier 2 (Preferred Brand): $35 copay per 30-day supply

Tier 3 (Non-Preferred Brand): $70 copay per 30-day supply

Tier 4 (Specialty): 20% coinsurance after deductible

Mail-order prescriptions for maintenance medications are available at 2.5 times the 30-day copay for a 90-day supply.

3. EXCLUSIONS

3.1 General Exclusions

This policy does not cover: cosmetic procedures not medically necessary, experimental or investigational treatments, services received outside the United States except for emergency care, dental care except as stated in Section 2, vision care except for diabetic eye exams, custodial care or long-term care, weight loss programs or bariatric surgery unless medically necessary, and infertility treatments beyond initial diagnosis.

3.2 Pre-existing Conditions

Pre-existing conditions are covered under this policy after a waiting period of 12 months from the effective date of coverage, provided the policyholder maintains continuous coverage during that period. A pre-existing condition is defined as any condition for which the policyholder received diagnosis, treatment, or medical advice in the 12 months prior to the effective date.

3.3 Limitations on Mental Health Services

Mental health and substance use disorder services are subject to the same cost-sharing as medical and surgical services. Inpatient psychiatric care is limited to 30 days per calendar year. Outpatient mental health visits are limited to 52 sessions per calendar year.

4. COST SHARING

4.1 Annual Deductible

The annual deductible is $1,500 per individual and $3,000 per family. The deductible resets on January 1 of each calendar year. Preventive care services and Tier 1 prescription drugs do not apply toward the deductible.

4.2 Copayments and Coinsurance

After the deductible is met, the following cost-sharing applies:

Primary care visit: $25 copay

Specialist visit: $50 copay

Emergency room: $250 copay (waived if admitted)

Urgent care: $75 copay

Outpatient surgery: 20% coinsurance

Inpatient hospitalization: $500 per admission

4.3 Out-of-Pocket Maximum

The annual out-of-pocket maximum is $7,000 per individual and $14,000 per family. Once this limit is reached, the plan covers 100% of covered services for the remainder of the calendar year. The out-of-pocket maximum includes deductibles, copayments, and coinsurance but does not include premiums or charges for non-covered services.

5. CLAIMS

5.1 Filing a Claim

In-network providers submit claims directly to Blue Shield on behalf of the policyholder. For out-of-network services, the policyholder must submit a completed claim form along with an itemised bill within 180 days of the date of service. Claim forms are available at blueshield.com or by calling member services at 1-800-555-0100.

5.2 Claim Review and Payment

Claims are typically processed within 30 days of receipt. If additional information is needed, Blue Shield will notify the policyholder within 15 days. Payment for approved claims is made directly to the provider for in-network services, or to the policyholder for out-of-network reimbursements.

5.3 Disputes and Appeals

If a claim is denied, the policyholder has the right to appeal within 180 days of receiving the denial notice. Appeals must be submitted in writing and include a statement of the reasons for the appeal along with any supporting medical documentation. Blue Shield will respond to appeals within 60 days. If the appeal is denied, the policyholder may request an independent external review.

6. TERMINATION

6.1 Voluntary Termination

The policyholder may cancel coverage at any time by providing 30 days written notice to Blue Shield. Coverage continues through the end of the calendar month in which the notice is received. Premiums paid beyond the termination date will be refunded within 30 days.

6.2 Involuntary Termination

Blue Shield may terminate coverage for any of the following reasons: non-payment of premiums after a 30-day grace period, material misrepresentation on the application, loss of eligibility as defined in Section 1, or fraud or intentional deception in obtaining benefits. Written notice will be provided at least 30 days before termination except in cases of fraud.

6.3 Continuation of Coverage

Upon termination of group coverage, eligible individuals may continue coverage under COBRA for up to 18 months. COBRA election must be made within 60 days of receiving the COBRA notice. The policyholder is responsible for the full premium plus a 2% administrative fee during the COBRA period.

7. CONTACT INFORMATION

Contact Details

Member Services: 1-800-555-0100 (Monday to Friday, 8am to 8pm EST)

Claims Department: claims@blueshield.com

Provider Directory: blueshield.com/providers

Pharmacy Benefits: 1-800-555-0199

Mental Health Line: 1-800-555-0177 (24 hours, 7 days a week)

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